

DRAIN

1. Passage anchor

> “At that time, I had been feeling quite ****drained**** from work...”

Passage meaning

****drained**** = extremely tired, especially mentally or emotionally, as if all your energy has been used up

****筋疲力盡的；心力交瘁的；精疲力竭的****

Here, work has left the speaker mentally and emotionally exhausted.

Practice

1. I felt completely ****drained**** after a long week at work.

忙了一整個星期後，我感到****筋疲力盡****。

2. The constant pressure left her emotionally ****drained****.

持續的壓力讓她在情緒上****心力交瘁****。

Core verb meanings

2. drain — remove liquid from something

= cause liquid to flow out of a container, area, food, etc.

****排出；瀝乾；放掉液體****

Examples

1. ****Drain the water**** from the sink.

把水槽裡的水****排掉****。

2. ****Drain the pasta**** before adding the sauce.

加醬汁前先把意大利麵****瀝乾****。

This is the central literal verb sense.

3. drain something

= empty liquid from a place or container

****把.....排乾；放乾****

Examples

1. They ****drained the pool**** for repairs.
他們為了維修把泳池的水****放乾****。
2. The farmer ****drained the field**** after the heavy rain.
大雨後，農夫把田裡的積水****排走****。

4. drain away / drain off

= flow away or be removed gradually

****流走；排走****

Examples

1. The rainwater slowly ****drained away****.
雨水慢慢****排走了****。
2. ****Drain off**** the excess oil.
把多餘的油****瀝掉****。

Noun: pipe/opening for liquid

5. drain — pipe/channel carrying away liquid

= pipe, opening, or channel through which waste water or other liquid flows away

****排水管；排水口；下水道****

Examples

1. The kitchen ****drain**** is blocked.
廚房的****排水口****堵塞了。
2. Water disappeared down the ****drain****.
水流進了****排水管****。

Major distinct noun sense.

6. storm drain

= drain designed to carry rainwater away from streets

雨水排水口；雨水渠

Examples

1. Leaves blocked the **storm drain**.

樹葉堵住了**雨水渠**。

2. Water rushed into the **storm drain**.

水湧進了**雨水排水口**。

Exhaust / use up energy

7. drain — use up someone's energy

= make someone extremely tired physically, mentally, or emotionally

耗盡精力；使疲憊不堪

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. Long meetings **drain me**.

長時間會議會**耗盡我的精力**。

2. Constant conflict can **drain you emotionally**.

持續的衝突會讓人在情緒上**筋疲力盡**。

8. be / feel drained

= feel as though all physical or emotional energy has disappeared

感到精疲力竭；心力交瘁

Examples

1. I felt **drained** after the interview.

面試後我感到**精疲力竭**。

2. She looked emotionally **drained**.

她看起來在情緒上已經**心力交瘁**。

This is the exact passage form.

9. emotionally drained

= having little emotional energy left after stress, conflict, or intense experience

****情緒耗盡的；心力交瘁****

Examples

1. Caring for everyone else left her ****emotionally drained****.
一直照顧別人讓她****心力交瘁****。
2. After weeks of uncertainty, they were ****emotionally drained****.
經歷幾星期的不確定後，他們都****情緒耗盡****。

Use up resources

10. drain — consume resources

= gradually use up money, time, energy, supplies, etc.

****耗盡；消耗****

Examples

1. The repairs ****drained our savings****.
維修費****耗掉了我們的積蓄****。
2. The project ****drained a huge amount of time and money****.
這個專案****耗費了大量時間和金錢****。

Major figurative extension.

11. drain resources

= consume resources heavily

****消耗資源****

Examples

1. The crisis **drained public resources**.

危機**消耗了公共資源**。

2. Maintaining the old system **drains staff time**.

維護舊系統會大量**消耗員工時間**。

Battery / electricity

12. drain a battery

= use up the stored electrical energy in a battery

耗盡電池電量

Examples

1. Video calls can **drain your battery** quickly.

視像通話可能很快**耗光電池**。

2. The app was **draining the phone's battery**.

那個應用程式一直在**消耗手機電量**。

Very common modern extension.

13. battery drain

= loss or rapid consumption of battery power

耗電；電池電量流失

Examples

1. Users reported severe **battery drain**.

用戶回報出現嚴重**耗電問題**。

2. Background activity can cause **battery drain**.

背景活動可能造成**電池電量快速流失**。

Money / finances

14. drain on finances/resources

= something that continually consumes money, resources, or capacity

****財務 / 資源負擔；持續消耗****

Examples

1. The empty building became a ****drain on the company's finances****.

那棟空置建築成了公司財務上的****沉重負擔****。

2. The outdated system is a ****drain on resources****.

舊系統一直在****消耗資源****。

15. a drain on someone/something

= something that steadily uses up energy, money, time, etc.

****對.....造成持續消耗 / 負擔****

Examples

1. The commute was a ****drain on his energy****.

通勤對他的精力是一種****持續消耗****。

2. The process became a ****drain on staff time****.

那個流程成了對員工時間的****沉重負擔****。

Remove people/resources from a place

16. drain — remove people/talent/resources gradually

= cause an area, organization, etc. to lose valuable people or resources

****使流失；抽走****

Examples

1. Low wages ****drained talent from the industry****.

低薪導致人才從該行業****流失****。

2. Years of migration ****drained the town of young workers****.

多年人口遷移令小鎮的年輕勞動力大量****流失****。

17. brain drain

= loss of highly educated or skilled people from a country or organization to another place

****人才外流；腦力流失****

Examples

1. The country faced a serious ****brain drain****.

該國面臨嚴重的****人才外流****。

2. Better opportunities abroad contributed to the ****brain drain****.

海外更好的機會加劇了****人才流失****。

Important lexicalized compound.

Empty / disappear

18. drain from someone's face

= color or expression suddenly disappear, often because of shock or fear

****臉色褪去；臉色變白****

Examples

1. The color ****drained from her face**** when she heard the news.

她聽到消息後****臉色一下子變白了****。

2. He felt the blood ****drain from his face****.

他感到自己****臉色瞬間發白****。

Strong figurative extension from liquid flowing away.

Landscape / hydrology

19. drain — carry water away from land

= allow or cause water to flow away from an area

****排水****

Examples

1. The soil ****drains well****.

這種土壤****排水良好****。

2. This field does not ****drain**** properly.

這塊田的****排水不良****。

20. well-drained

= allowing excess water to flow away easily

****排水良好的****

Examples

1. The plant prefers ****well-drained soil****.

這種植物喜歡****排水良好的土壤****。

2. Use a ****well-drained**** growing medium.

使用****排水良好的****培養介質。

Plumbing expression

21. down the drain

A. literally into a drain

****流進排水口****

B. figuratively wasted or lost

****付諸東流；白白浪費****

Examples

1. The water went ****down the drain****.

水流進了****排水口****。

2. Months of work went ****down the drain****.

幾個月的工作全都****付諸東流****。

Very high-value idiom.

Related forms

22. drainage

= system or process by which water/liquid is carried away

****排水；排水系統****

Examples

1. The area has poor ****drainage****.
這個地區的****排水系統****很差。
2. Good ****drainage**** is important for these plants.
良好的****排水****對這些植物很重要。

23. draining

= very tiring or exhausting

****令人筋疲力盡的；消耗精力的****

Examples

1. It was an emotionally ****draining**** conversation.
那是一場非常****消耗情緒能量的談話****。
2. The job can be mentally ****draining****.
這份工作可能非常****耗費精神****。

Important distinction from ****drained****.

24. drained

A. emptied of liquid

****已排乾的****

1. The pool had been completely ****drained****.
泳池的水已經完全****放乾****。

B. exhausted

****筋疲力盡的****

2. I felt completely ****drained****.

我感到完全****精疲力竭****。

Context determines the sense.

25. drainer

= device or person used for draining; appears especially in compounds such as dish drainer

****瀝水架；排水裝置****

Low priority.

Key contrasts

26. drain vs empty

****empty****

= remove everything from a container

****清空****

****drain****

= specifically remove liquid, often by allowing it to flow away

****排出 / 瀝乾液體****

Compare:

> empty the box

> 清空箱子

> drain the sink

> 把水槽裡的水排掉

27. drain vs exhaust

****exhaust****

= use up completely or make someone extremely tired

****耗盡；使精疲力竭****

****drain****

= suggests energy/resources gradually flowing away until little remains

****逐漸耗盡****

Compare:

> The work ****exhausted**** me.

> 工作讓我筋疲力盡。

> The constant tension ****drained**** me.

> 持續的緊張慢慢耗光了我的精力。

28. drained vs tired

****tired****

= needing rest

****累的****

****drained****

= much stronger; feeling as though energy has been emptied out

****精疲力竭的；心力交瘁的****

In the passage, ****drained**** is more expressive than simply ****tired****.

29. drained vs burnt out

****drained****

= exhausted at a particular time, physically or emotionally

****精疲力竭****

****burnt out****

= prolonged state of severe exhaustion and reduced motivation, often after chronic stress

****身心耗竭****

Being drained does not necessarily mean burnout.

30. drained vs draining

****drained****

= describes the person or thing that has lost energy

****感到精疲力竭的****

****draining****

= describes what causes energy to be lost

****令人疲憊的****

Compare:

> I feel ****drained****.

> 我感到筋疲力盡。

> The job is ****draining****.

> 這份工作非常消耗精力。

Meaning map

The central literal concept of ****drain**** is:

****cause something to flow out until little or nothing remains****

From this develop:

Liquid

drain water

→ ****排水 / 瀝乾****

Plumbing

drain

→ ****排水口 / 排水管****

Land

soil drains well

→ ****排水良好****

Then the “something flows away until depleted” metaphor develops:

Energy

work drains me

→ ****耗盡精力****

Passage

feel drained
→ **心力交瘁**

Money

drain savings
→ **耗掉積蓄**

Battery

drain a battery
→ **耗盡電量**

Resources

drain resources
→ **消耗資源**

Talent

brain drain
→ **人才外流**

Appearance

color drains from someone's face
→ **臉色褪去 / 發白**

The passage uses the emotional-energy branch:

> **feeling quite drained from work**
> → **因工作而感到心力交瘁**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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drain — remove liquid	讓水或其他液體流出；排出 / 瀝乾
drain a pool/sink/field	把泳池、水槽、土地等的水排走
drain away/off	液體逐漸流走 / 被瀝掉
drain — noun plumbing	讓廢水等流走的排水口 / 排水管
storm drain	收集並排走雨水的雨水渠 / 排水口
drain — energy	大量消耗某人的身體、精神或情緒能量
feel/be drained	感覺所有精力幾乎被耗盡；精疲力竭 / 心力交瘁

emotionally drained	因長期壓力、衝突等而情緒能量耗盡	
drain money/resources	持續大量消耗金錢、時間、資源等	
drain a battery	把電池的儲存電量耗掉	
battery drain	電池電量快速 / 持續流失；耗電	
a drain on something	對金錢、時間、精力等造成持續消耗的負擔	
drain talent/people from somewhere	使人才或人口逐漸從某地 / 組織流失	
brain drain	熟練 / 高學歷人才大量離開某地；人才外流	
color drains from someone's face	因震驚、害怕等突然臉色變白	
soil/land drains	土壤 / 土地能讓多餘水分流走	
well-drained	水分能順利排走的；排水良好的	
down the drain — literal	流進排水口	
down the drain — figurative	努力、金錢等完全浪費；付諸東流	
drainage	排走水分的過程或排水系統	
draining — exhausting	大量消耗精神、體力或情緒能量的	
drained — liquid	液體已被排乾的	
drained — exhaustion	精力被耗盡的；筋疲力竭的	

Passage recap

> “I had been feeling quite **drained from work**...”

Here:

****drained** = **extremely tired and low in mental or emotional energy because of work****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **心力交瘁的**

* **精疲力竭的**

* **精神被耗光的**

Natural contextual translation:

****那段時間我工作上有點心力交瘁。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****drained****

= ****feeling as though most or all of your physical, mental, or emotional energy has been used up****

****筋疲力盡的；心力交瘁的****

The metaphor comes directly from the literal verb:

> ****drain a container****

> → 把裡面的液體排空

then figuratively:

> ****work drains you****

> → 工作像把人的精力慢慢「抽乾」

So:

> ****tired****

> → 累

but:

> ****drained****

> → ****像整個人的能量都被抽乾了****.